

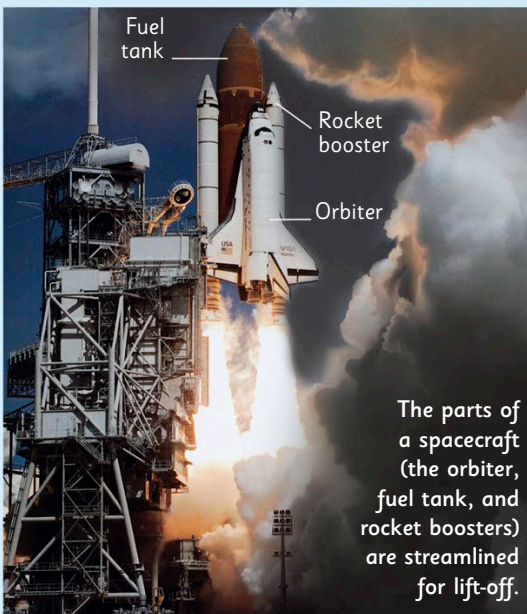
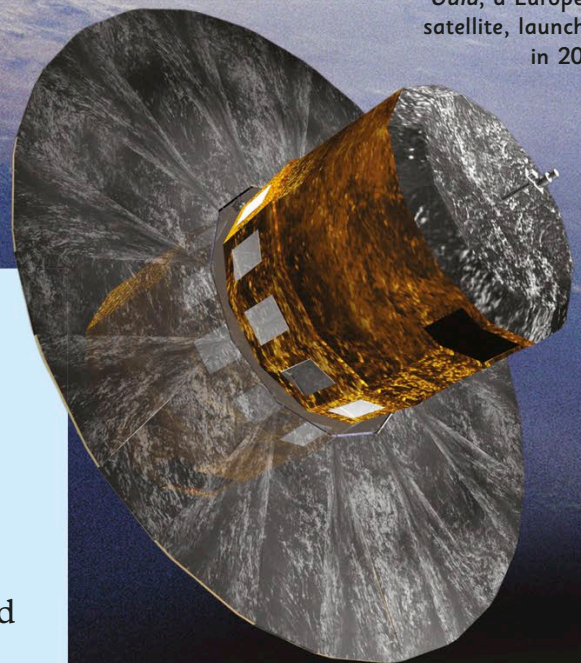


## Space badge

The US space agency NASA (National Aeronautics and Space Administration) awards astronaut wings to service personnel and civilians who have flown more than 80 km (50 miles) above the Earth's surface. Shown here are civilian astronaut wings.

If you could drive a car straight up, it would take only about an hour to reach space.

*Gaia*, a European satellite, launched in 2013



The parts of a spacecraft (the orbiter, fuel tank, and rocket boosters) are streamlined for lift-off.

## Slipping through air

A spacecraft has to be streamlined to move easily and safely through air. Where necessary, an extra part, called a fairing, is added to achieve this effect. A nose cone – the front end of a rocket, or aircraft – is an example of a fairing.

## Space hat-ellite

Up in space, satellites can be any shape at all. They don't need to be streamlined, because there's no air there.